

A second life for waste

Waste to Wealth

Sorted at home, waste can be sold or turned into compost. Mixed together, it is just rubbish.

Small actions. Cleaner communities.
A greener Pakistan.

VSO Volunteers spark others

WHY IT MATTERS

Where does it go?

The same waste can end up two ways. Which way is decided at home.

Blocked drains

Smoke we breathe

Dumps that rot

IF IT IS MIXED AND DUMPED

IF IT IS KEPT APART

It becomes something.

PHOTO TO ADD

Three bags of sorted waste at a front door

Food scraps
Compost

Paper and card
New paper, boxes

Metal and glass
Melted, made again

Plastic
Shredded, remade

Money and compost, instead of rubbish.

1

STEP 1 OF 3

Refuse and rethink.

The cheapest waste is the waste you never bring home.

BEFORE YOU TAKE A PLASTIC ITEM, CIRCLE ONE

- ✓ ✗ **Do I really need it?**
- ✓ ✗ **Will I use it more than once?**
- ✓ ✗ **Can it be recycled where I live?**

Any cross? Leave it on the shelf. Better still, bring your own bag, bottle or box.

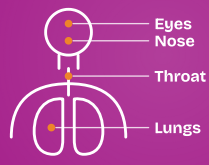
Say no to single-use plastic

- Shopping bags
- Straws
- Cups and plates
- Bottles
- Food wrappers
- Spoons and forks

Don't burn your rubbish.

The smoke irritates the eyes, nose and throat. Tiny particles go deep into the lungs.

Instead: sort it, sell it, compost it.



2

STEP 2 OF 3

Sort and use.

Sorting keeps waste worth something. Mixed, it is worth nothing.

Three colours: green, blue, red.

No coloured bins? Three bags or boxes will do. Use the same colours at home and on your street.



STEP 2 · SORT

GREEN

Organic

Peels, food scraps, leaves, garden waste.

MAKE COMPOST

Mix with dry leaves or torn paper. Keep it damp, turn it now and then, and wait.

BLUE

Recyclable

Paper, cardboard, cans, glass, plastic bottles and tubs.

SELL IT

Keep it clean and dry. Sell it to a scrap dealer or take it to a collection point.

RED

Special

Batteries, electronics, chemicals, medicines, sharp things, sanitary waste.

KEEP IT APART

In its own bag, wrapped. Ask your local authority where to hand it in.



Respect the people who handle our waste

Wrap broken glass and needles. Sort properly. Treat waste workers with dignity.

3

STEP 3 OF 3

Track and reduce.

The 7-day challenge. Weigh what leaves your home for a week, then work out what it is worth.

My week of waste

WEEK OF _____

WASTE	KG	PRICE PER KG	WORTH (RS)
Food waste		*compost it*	–
Plastic			
Paper and card			
Glass			
Metal			
Special waste		*keep apart*	–
Everything else		–	–

My week of recyclables is worth

No scales? The scrap dealer weighs it when you sell. Prices change, so write them in pencil.

PHOTO TO ADD

A scrap dealer weighing a household's paper or cans

Ask the scrap dealer

1. What do you buy, and what not?
2. What is today's price per kg?
3. Will you collect from our street?

What surprised us?

What will we cut next week?

STEP 3 · TRACK

FROM ONE HOME TO ONE STREET

The 8-week action plan.

A home that sorts has a habit. A street that sorts can ask for sorted collection.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8

WEEK

RINGED WEEKS: DO THE 7-DAY CHALLENGE

1

IDENTIFY WEEKS 1–2

Form a team. Map who already collects waste, who cleans up, and who could help.

SHOW WEEKS 3–4

With permission, put out model bins in the three colours. Sort a heap of mixed waste in public.

2

3

COORDINATE WEEKS 5–6

Meet the local authority, collectors, shops, schools and scrap dealers. Agree who keeps each area clean.

ADVOCATE WEEKS 7–8

Ask collectors to keep sorted waste sorted. Ask the municipality, or its contractor, to take charge of collection.

4

YOUR STREET

Your result: compare week 1 with week 8. The difference is what your street changed.

PHOTO TO ADD

Volunteers setting up a bin

THE LAW

What the law says.

Each province and region has its own law. These are the most a court can order, not what everyone pays.

Islamabad
Pakistan Environmental Protection Act 1997; Single-Use Plastics Regulations 2023

Fine up to
Rs 1 million
Repeat offence: up to 2 years in prison

Punjab
Punjab Environmental Protection Act 1997, amended 2012

Fine up to
Rs 5 million
Repeat offence: up to 2 years in prison

Sindh
Sindh Environmental Protection Act 2014

Fine up to
Rs 5 million
Repeat offence: up to 3 years in prison

Khyber Pakhtunkhwa
KP Environmental Protection Act 2014; Amendment Act 2022

Fine
Rs 50,000 to Rs 5 million
Repeat offence: up to 2 years in prison

Balochistan
Balochistan Environmental Protection Act 2012

Fine up to
Rs 1 million
Repeat offence: up to 2 years in prison

Gilgit-Baltistan
Gilgit-Baltistan Environmental Protection Act 2014

Fine up to
Rs 1 million
Repeat offence: up to 2 years in prison

Azad Jammu and Kashmir
AJK Environmental Protection Act 2000

Fine up to
Rs 1 million
Repeat offence: up to 2 years in prison

At home, the rule is simple: don't burn waste, don't dump it in drains or empty plots, and keep special waste apart.

also covers plastic bags. All seven cover pollution and hazardous waste. Check with your provincial EPA before relying on a figure. Last checked October 2026.

WASTE CHAMPION

MY PLEDGE

Starting today, I will

- [ ] Carry my own bag and bottle
- [ ] Say no to plastic I don't need
- [ ] Sort my waste three ways
- [ ] Sell or compost what I can
- [ ] Never burn rubbish
- [ ] Show one neighbour how

NAME _____ DATE _____

AT HOME, ASK

"What can I change?"

ON YOUR STREET, ASK

"Who is responsible for collecting our waste?"

VSO Volunteers spark others